

# CLAT Express - March 2026: Study Notes

Chapters, topics and sub-topics with key facts, memory aids and mind-map outlines.

## International Relations and News

### US-Israel Joint Offensive Against Iran

#### Iran-Israel Rivalry and the Axis of Resistance

Iran and Israel were allies during the Shah's reign, but relations turned hostile after the 1979 revolution, when the new Islamic government broke all ties with Israel. The Revolutionary Guard Corps then built a network of armed groups called the Axis of Resistance to confront Israel and its rivals. Its members include Hezbollah in Lebanon, Hamas in Gaza and Ansar Allah (Houthis) in Yemen.

- Iran and Israel were allies during the reign of Shah Mohammad Reza Pahlavi.
- The Shah was ousted in 1979 and an Islamic State was established in Iran.
- The Khomeini government broke all relations with Israel after 1979.
- The Shah ordered Khomeini to leave Iran in 1964; Khomeini then led the revolution from Iraq.
- Khomeini called America the 'Big Devil' and Israel the 'Little Devil'.
- The IRGC created the Axis of Resistance, a network of armed groups.
- Hezbollah (Lebanon) was formed to fight Israeli forces that had invaded Lebanon in 1982.
- Hamas (Gaza City) is linked to the outbreak of the First Intifada against Israel.
- Ansar Allah emerged in Yemen as an opposition movement against President Ali Abdullah Saleh.
- Iran supports the Houthis in Yemen and Hezbollah in Lebanon as pressure fronts against Israel.

Mind-map outline

Iran-Israel rivalry

- 1979 revolution
  - Shah Pahlavi ousted
  - Ties with Israel broken
- Khomeini
  - Ordered out of Iran in 1964
  - Israel as Little Devil
  - Led revolution from Iraq
- Axis of Resistance
  - IRGC built armed network
  - Hezbollah: Lebanon
  - Hamas: Gaza
  - Ansar Allah: Yemen

#### Strait of Hormuz and Global Energy Shock

The Strait of Hormuz links the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and is the only maritime outlet for the Gulf's oil and gas exports. The booklet warns that a blockade could push Brent crude prices up and possibly trigger a global energy crisis. Speculative demand from a risk premium can raise prices even before any supply is actually lost.

- The strait lies between Iran (north) and the Musandam Peninsula of Oman (south).
- It connects the Persian Gulf to the Gulf of Oman and further to the Arabian Sea.
- It is the only maritime outlet for the Persian Gulf's oil and gas exports.
- It carries nearly 20% of global oil supply.
- About 1/5 of global LNG trade and 1/3 of global fertiliser exports transit this corridor.
- Traders add a risk premium, which can create artificial price rises through speculative demand.
- Conflict could spill into the Red Sea or Suez Canal, raising transit times and freight costs.
- India imports about 85% of its crude oil.
- Each \$1 rise in oil price adds about \$1.5 billion a year to India's import bill.
- Nearly 40% of India's crude oil imports and over 80% of its LPG imports pass through the strait.

Mnemonic - Hormuz numbers: Twenty Oil, Fifth Gas, Eighty-Five India

Twenty = About 20% of global oil supply transits the strait; Fifth = About 1/5 of global LNG trade

transits the strait; Eighty-Five = India imports about 85% of its crude oil

Mind-map outline

Strait of Hormuz

- Geography
  - Iran north, Oman's Musandam south
  - Links Persian Gulf to Arabian Sea
- Global share
  - About 20% of oil supply
  - 1/5 of LNG trade
  - 1/3 of fertiliser exports
- Price effects
  - Risk premium lifts prices
  - Brent crude may surge
- India exposure
  - About 85% crude imported
  - About \$1.5bn import bill per \$1 rise

## Nuclear Talks and Military Strikes

Nuclear talks in Geneva collapsed over US demands that Iran dismantle Fordow and Natanz and halt uranium enrichment. The joint offensive then used heavy bombers, including US B-2 bunker-buster strikes on Fordow. Iran responded with missiles, including the Sejil, in strikes on Israeli and US military bases.

- The 2015 JCPOA was signed between Iran and the P5+1 group of countries.
- Under the JCPOA, Iran agreed to limit uranium enrichment to 3.67%.
- The US withdrew from the JCPOA unilaterally in 2018 and reinstated sanctions.
- Geneva talks collapsed over US demands to dismantle Fordow and Natanz and halt enrichment.
- US B-2 bombers used bunker-buster bombs to strike the fortified Fordow facility.
- US airstrikes targeted Kharg Island, which handles nearly 90% of Iran's crude oil exports.
- Iranian missiles struck near the heavily protected Dimona nuclear research centre.
- The US B-1B Lancer, nicknamed 'Bone', was deployed in Operation Epic Fury.
- The Sejil is a two-stage, solid-fuel, medium-range ballistic missile.
- The Sejil is called the 'Dancing Missile' for its high-altitude manoeuvrability.

Mind-map outline

Nuclear talks and strikes

- Nuclear diplomacy
  - JCPOA signed 2015
  - Enrichment limit 3.67%
  - US exit in 2018
- Strikes
  - B-2 bunker-busters on Fordow
  - Airstrikes on Kharg Island
  - Dimona area struck
- Missiles
  - Sejil: two-stage solid fuel
  - Sejil: Dancing Missile
  - B-1B Lancer 'Bone'

## Iran's Supreme Leader

Mojtaba Khamenei was named Iran's third Supreme Leader after Ali Khamenei was assassinated, the first hereditary-style transfer since the revolution. The office holds ultimate authority over Iran's political, military and religious institutions. The leader is chosen by the 88-member Assembly of Experts, and the office's authority derives from the doctrine of Velayat-e Faqih.

- Mojtaba Khamenei was named the third Supreme Leader after Ali Khamenei's assassination.
- This was the first hereditary-style leadership transfer in Iran since the revolution.
- The Supreme Leader is Iran's de jure head of state and commander-in-chief of the armed forces.
- The office oversees national security and foreign policy and influences the election vetting process.
- The Supreme Leader's authority derives from Velayat-e Faqih (Guardianship of the Islamic Jurist).

- Ruhollah Khomeini institutionalised this doctrine and was Iran's first Supreme Leader.
- The Assembly of Experts is an 88-member clerical body elected by the public.
- The Assembly of Experts elects the leader, supervises his performance and can remove him if unfit.
- The 1989 constitutional amendment relaxed the earlier requirement that the leader be a Marja.

Mnemonic - Leader selection: Eighty-Eight Elect and Can Remove

Eighty-Eight = The Assembly of Experts has 88 members; Elect = The Assembly of Experts chooses the Supreme Leader; Remove = The Assembly can remove the leader if deemed unfit

Mind-map outline

Iran's Supreme Leader

- Powers
  - Commander-in-chief
  - Oversight of foreign policy
  - Appoints senior officials
- Selection
  - Assembly of Experts: 88 members
  - 1989 amendment relaxed Marja rule
  - Can be removed if unfit
- Doctrine
  - Velayat-e Faqih
  - Institutionalised by Khomeini
- 2026 transfer
  - Mojtaba named third leader
  - First hereditary-style transfer

## India's Energy Security and Reserves

India imports about 85% of its crude oil, and a large share of its crude and LPG imports transit the Strait of Hormuz. Its Strategic Petroleum Reserves are meant to cushion supply shocks, with current storage of about 3.37 MMT against a total capacity of 5.33 MMT. The government invoked the Essential Commodities Act, 1955 to ensure LPG availability during the crisis.

- India imports about 85% of its crude oil.
- Nearly 40% of India's crude oil imports pass through the Strait of Hormuz.
- More than 80% of India's LPG imports also transit the same route.
- Qatar supplies nearly half of India's LNG imports.
- Global crude oil prices have risen by about \$20 per barrel (about 30%).
- India's Strategic Petroleum Reserve has a total capacity of 5.33 million tonnes, with about 3.37 MMT in storage.
- The Indian Strategic Petroleum Reserves Limited manages the SPR under the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas.
- The global norm is to maintain 90 days of net oil import reserves.
- The Essential Commodities Act, 1955 was invoked to ensure LPG availability.
- West Asia accounts for 60-70% of India's basmati rice exports.

Mind-map outline

India's energy security

- Oil and LPG exposure
  - About 85% crude imported
  - Nearly 40% crude via Hormuz
  - Over 80% LPG via Hormuz
- Reserves
  - SPR capacity 5.33 MMT
  - About 3.37 MMT in storage
  - Norm: 90 days of imports
- Government response
  - Essential Commodities Act 1955
  - LPG output boost ordered
- Other links
  - Qatar: half of LNG imports
  - West Asia: 60-70% of basmati exports

## **Pakistan Declares Open War on Afghanistan's Taliban Government**

### **Regime changes in Afghanistan (1973-2021)**

Afghanistan's political history since 1973 has seen a series of regimes, each shaped by outside powers. The monarchy ended in 1973 and was followed by Soviet-backed communist rule, and Soviet military intervention in 1979 drew Pakistan into supporting Afghan Mujahideen factions. Civil war after 1992 led to Taliban rule, which ended with the US intervention of 2001, and the Taliban regained full control after the US withdrawal in August 2021.

- Afghanistan's monarchy ended in 1973.
- The nationalist regime was followed by communist rule backed by the Soviet Union.
- In 1979 the Soviet Union intervened militarily in Afghanistan.
- Pakistan supported Afghan Mujahideen factions during the Soviet intervention.
- President Najibullah's government collapsed in 1992, triggering civil war.
- The Taliban emerged in 1994 and captured Kabul in 1996.
- Pakistan was one of the few countries to recognise the Taliban regime.
- After the 9/11 attacks, the United States invaded Afghanistan and overthrew the Taliban.
- The new Islamic Republic struggled with insurgency and corruption.
- After the US withdrawal in August 2021, the Taliban regained full control.

Mind-map outline

Afghan regime changes

- 1973: monarchy ends
- 1979: Soviet intervention; Pakistan backs Mujahideen
- 1992: Najibullah government collapses
- Taliban rule
  - Emerged 1994
  - Captured Kabul 1996
  - Recognised by Pakistan
- 2001-21: US intervention, Islamic Republic
- 2021: Taliban return

### **Factors behind the open war**

Pakistan launched Operation Ghazab-Lil-Haq on Afghan military bases, and Afghanistan retaliated with airstrikes on Pakistani targets. The escalation grew out of long-standing disputes over cross-border militancy, the Durand Line and border fencing. Clashes at disputed checkpoints turned these tensions into direct military confrontation.

- Pakistan launched Operation Ghazab-Lil-Haq on Afghan military bases.
- Afghanistan retaliated with airstrikes on Nur Khan Airbase (Rawalpindi) and 12th Division HQ (Quetta).
- The Afghan Taliban is allegedly sheltering Tehrik-i-Taliban Pakistan (TTP).
- TTP is accused of launching cross-border attacks inside Pakistan.
- Pakistan recognises the Durand Line as a permanent international border.
- Afghan governments have historically disputed the legitimacy of the Durand Line.
- Pakistan's border fencing has been resisted by Afghan forces.
- Repeated Torkham crossing closures hurt Afghan trade and deepened mistrust.
- Pakistan's 'strategic depth' doctrine has been eroded by the Taliban's outreach to India.

Mind-map outline

Factors behind the open war

- Operation Ghazab-Lil-Haq launched
- Retaliatory strikes: Nur Khan, Quetta HQ
- Border tensions
  - TTP sanctuary allegations
  - Durand Line dispute
  - Border fencing resisted
  - Clashes at disputed checkpoints
- Trade and strategy
  - Torkham crossing closures

- Strategic depth eroded

## India-Afghanistan ties and projects

India and Afghanistan share historic links, including Gandhara's place among the Mahajanapadas of the Vedic Age and the Bamiyan Buddhas. Afghanistan is also a crossroad between South Asia and Central Asia, and India has supported its energy, agriculture, drinking water and democratic institutions through projects. The Zaranj-Delaram Highway helps Afghanistan reach Iran's Chabahar Port while bypassing Pakistan.

- Gandhara, part of modern-day Afghanistan, was one of 16 Mahajanapadas in the Vedic Age.
- The Bamiyan Buddhas highlight the influence of Buddhism in Afghanistan.
- Afghanistan is a crossroad between South Asia and Central Asia, and between South Asia and the Middle East.
- TAPI (Peace) Pipeline: a 1814 km gas pipeline from the Galkynysh Gas Field in Turkmenistan through Afghanistan, Pakistan and India.
- Salma Dam (Afghan-India Friendship Dam), 2016, in Herat Province, supports energy and agriculture.
- Zaranj-Delaram Highway (2009) connects Afghanistan to Iran's Chabahar Port and was built by India's Border Roads Organization.
- Shahtoot Dam Project (2021) aims to provide drinking water to Kabul.
- Afghan Parliament Building (2015), built by India, symbolises India's commitment to Afghan democracy.

Mnemonic - TAPI pipeline route: Turkmen Afghan Pakistani Indian gas: TAPI

T = Turkmenistan: source of the gas (Galkynysh Gas Field); A = Afghanistan: pipeline route country; P = Pakistan: pipeline route country; I = India: pipeline route country

Mind-map outline

India-Afghanistan ties

- Historic links
  - Gandhara: one of 16 Mahajanapadas
  - Bamiyan Buddhas: Buddhist influence
- Development projects
  - TAPI gas pipeline (1814 km)
  - Salma Dam, Herat (2016)
  - Zaranj-Delaram Highway (2009)
  - Shahtoot Dam, Kabul water (2021)
  - Afghan Parliament Building (2015)
- Strategic importance
  - Crossroad: South and Central Asia
  - Route to Chabahar Port

## Implications for India

The Pakistan-Afghanistan conflict has several implications for India, touching its western border, its security and its trade routes. Escalation may reduce Pakistan's infiltration pressure along the LoC, but prolonged instability could let ISIS-K regroup and jeopardise India's access to the INSTC. India condemned Pakistan's attacks and reaffirmed support for Afghanistan's sovereignty, territorial integrity and independence.

- India condemned Pakistan's attacks and reaffirmed support for Afghanistan's sovereignty, territorial integrity and independence.
- LoC relief: escalation on the western border may compel Pakistan to reduce infiltration pressure along the LoC.
- Terror spillover: prolonged instability risks allowing ISIS-K to regroup and expand across South Asia.
- Connectivity risks: the conflict jeopardises India's access to the INSTC and Central Asian trade outreach.
- Refugee pressure: a full-scale conflict risks an Afghan refugee inflow onto India's borders.

Mnemonic - Risks for India: Lazy Tigers Chase Rabbits

L = LoC relief from reduced infiltration pressure; T = Terror spillover (ISIS-K); C = Connectivity risks to the INSTC; R = Refugee pressure

Mind-map outline

Implications for India

- LoC relief
- Terror spillover: ISIS-K
- Connectivity risks: INSTC
- Refugee pressure
- India condemned attacks

## **Nepal Election: RSP's Victory and Implications for India**

### **RSP Victory and the Gen Z Shift**

The Rastriya Swatantra Party, led by Balendra Shah, secured a landslide victory in Nepal's General Elections. The win followed the 2025 Gen Z Protests, which toppled the government of KP Sharma Oli. Anger over corruption, unemployment and the state's response to protesters fuelled the political change.

- RSP, led by Balendra Shah, secured a landslide victory in Nepal's General Elections.
- Balendra Shah is Mayor of Kathmandu and is also a rapper.
- At 35, Shah is set to become Nepal's youngest Prime Minister.
- Shah is a leader of Madhesh descent.
- The 2025 Gen Z Protests toppled the government of KP Sharma Oli.
- Youth discontent was driven by corruption and elite privileges ('Nepo Kids').
- Rising unemployment and lack of accountability added to the frustration.
- Government banned 26 social media platforms, cutting off Gen Z's primary medium of expression.
- Security forces firing on protesters further escalated anger.

Mind-map outline

RSP Victory and Gen Z Shift

- Causes of the crisis
  - Corruption and elite privileges
  - Rising unemployment
  - Social media ban on 26 platforms
  - Firing on protesters
- Outcome
  - Oli government toppled
  - Shah set to be youngest PM

### **Nepal's Political System and Parties**

Nepal is a Federal Democratic Republic with a multi-party system under its 2015 Constitution. Its Parliament is bicameral, and the House of Representatives combines FPTP and PR seats. Political instability is a long-standing feature, and no government has completed a full term since the restoration of democracy in 1990.

- The Constitution of Nepal was adopted in 2015.
- Nepal is a Federal Democratic Republic with a multi-party system.
- The President is the ceremonial head of state; the Prime Minister is head of government.
- Parliament is bicameral: House of Representatives and National Assembly.
- FPTP: candidate with the highest votes wins. PR: seats allocated by party vote share.
- The 275-member House of Representatives has 165 FPTP seats and 110 PR seats.
- No government has completed a full term since the restoration of democracy in 1990.
- Nepali Congress was founded in 1947, CPN-UML in 1991 and CPN-Maoist Centre in 1994.
- KP Sharma Oli, CPN-UML leader, has served as Prime Minister for the 4th time since 2015.
- Oli succeeded Pushpa Kamal Dahal (Prachanda), who had been Prime Minister since 2009.

Mnemonic - House of Representatives seats: Sixty-Five Past the Post, One-Ten by Vote Share  
Sixty-Five = 165 seats elected via FPTP; One-Ten = 110 seats allocated through PR

Mind-map outline

Nepal's Political System and Parties

- Constitution and structure
  - Adopted 2015
- Federal democratic republic

- Bicameral parliament
- Electoral system
  - FPTP: 165 seats
  - PR: 110 seats by vote share
- Parties and leaders
  - Nepali Congress (1947)
  - CPN-UML (1991): KP Sharma Oli
  - CPN-Maoist Centre (1994): Prachanda

## Challenges and Gains for India

Shah's assertive nationalism could harden Nepal's stance on the Kalapani-Limpiyadhura dispute and the 1950 Treaty. The decline of traditional parties means New Delhi must rebuild its diplomatic networks. A stable single-party majority and technocratic governance could align with India's Neighbourhood First Policy.

- The Kalapani-Limpiyadhura dispute could harden Nepal's stance under Shah's assertive nationalism.
- RSP proposes revisiting the 1950 India-Nepal Treaty of Peace and Friendship.
- Revisiting the treaty could reduce India's traditional diplomatic leverage in Kathmandu.
- Nepal's effort to reduce dependence on India may redirect trade and connectivity projects toward others, including China.
- Decline of traditional parties requires New Delhi to rebuild diplomatic networks beyond long-standing channels.
- A single-party majority government could provide a stable environment for long-term policy.
- RSP's technocratic approach may align with India's Neighbourhood First Policy, especially cross-border rail, power grid and infrastructure.
- Madhesh lies in the Terai plains of south-eastern Nepal, bordering the Indian state of Bihar.
- Madhesh is often called the 'Granary of Nepal' and has demanded greater political representation.

Mind-map outline

Challenges and Gains for India

- Challenges
  - Kalapani-Limpiyadhura dispute
  - Revisiting 1950 treaty
  - Trade may shift toward China
- Gains
  - Single-party majority: stability
  - Neighbourhood First alignment
  - Madhesh borders Bihar

## India-Nepal Relations and Border Disputes

Nepal acts as a Himalayan buffer state between India and China, and the 1950 Treaty forms the base of bilateral ties. Trade, pipeline and rail projects deepen cooperation. Boundary disputes over the Kali river source and Kalapani remain unresolved.

- Nepal acts as a Himalayan buffer state between India and China.
- Nepal shares a border of 1751 km with 5 Indian states: Sikkim, West Bengal, Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand.
- The 1950 Treaty was signed by Indian Ambassador Chandreshwar Prasad Narain Singh and Nepal PM Mohun Shumshere Rana.
- India is Nepal's largest trade and investment partner; bilateral trade was \$8.5 billion in FY 2024-25.
- Motihari-Amlekhgunj Petroleum Pipeline is South Asia's first cross-border petroleum pipeline.
- Jayanagar-Kurtha Railway Line is a cross-border rail connectivity project.
- Treaty of Sugauli (1816) defined the Kali (Mahakali or Sarda) as the western boundary and the Mechi as the eastern boundary.
- Nepal claims Limpiyadhura as the Kali's source; India argues the river rises at Pankhagad, placing Kalapani in India.
- Kalapani has been guarded by the Indo-Tibetan Border Police since 1962.
- Nepal signed a Belt and Road Initiative framework with China in 2024.

Mnemonic - States sharing the Nepal border: Silly Wombats Bounce Up Utopia

Silly = Sikkim; Wombats = West Bengal; Bounce = Bihar; Up = Uttar Pradesh; Utopia = Uttarakhand

Mind-map outline

India-Nepal Relations

- Ties and treaties
  - 1950 Treaty of Peace and Friendship
  - Himalayan buffer between India and China
- Border
  - 1751 km, five Indian states
  - Kali river source dispute
  - Kalapani guarded by ITBP since 1962
- Connectivity
  - Motihari-Amlekhgunj pipeline
  - Jayanagar-Kurtha rail line

## India-Canada Relations: Reset, CEPA and Strains

### Background of Bilateral Ties

India and Canada established diplomatic ties in 1947 and cooperate in trade, nuclear energy and space. Bilateral trade was worth USD 30.9 billion in 2024. Their nuclear links include the CIRUS reactor (1954) and the Nuclear Cooperation Agreement (2013), and ISRO and the Canadian Space Agency collaborate in space.

- Diplomatic ties established in 1947.
- Bilateral trade worth USD 30.9 billion in 2024.
- Nuclear Cooperation Agreement (2013) facilitates uranium supply and oversight.
- Canada assisted India in building a nuclear research reactor named CIRUS in 1954.
- Space collaboration between ISRO and the Canadian Space Agency.
- Joint research collaboration exists between the two countries.

Mind-map outline

Background of Ties

- Diplomatic ties: 1947
- Trade: USD 30.9 billion (2024)
- Nuclear cooperation
  - 2013 agreement: uranium supply
  - CIRUS reactor built with Canadian help (1954)
- Space: ISRO and Canadian Space Agency

### Key Outcomes of the Canadian PM's Visit

Canadian PM Mark Carney signalled a reset with India, and formal CEPA trade talks restarted. The visit produced outcomes in energy, climate, technology, agriculture, student mobility and critical minerals. Several outcomes came with a stated target or time frame.

- Negotiations on CEPA formally restarted.
- Bilateral trade target set at \$50 billion by 2030.
- Canada's Cameco to supply uranium ore concentrates from 2027 to 2035.
- Canada announced intent to join the International Solar Alliance.
- Canada to upgrade to full membership in the Global Biofuels Alliance.
- ACITI (Australia-Canada-India Technology and Innovation) Partnership launched.
- ACITI focus: emerging technologies, digital innovation, advanced manufacturing.
- Pulse Protein Centre of Excellence set up at National Institute of Food Technology Entrepreneurship and Management.
- Fully funded research internships for 300 Indian students annually.
- MoU signed for secure and resilient critical minerals supply chains, aligned with the G7 Critical Minerals Action Plan.

Mnemonic - ACITI Partnership: A Cricket Idea Takes Innovation

A = Australia, one of the three partner countries; C = Canada, one of the three partner countries; I = India, one of the three partner countries; T = Technology, in the partnership's name; I = Innovation, in the partnership's name

Mind-map outline

Key Outcomes of Visit

- Trade
  - CEPA talks restarted
  - Target \$50 billion by 2030
- Energy
  - Cameco uranium supply 2027 to 2035
- Climate
  - Intent to join International Solar Alliance
  - Full membership in Global Biofuels Alliance
- Technology and agriculture
  - ACITI partnership
  - Pulse Protein Centre of Excellence
- People and minerals
  - 300 research internships a year
  - Critical minerals MoU

### **Diplomatic Strains and Trade Impact**

Ties deteriorated after PM Justin Trudeau alleged a potential link between Indian agents and the 2023 killing of Hardeep Singh Nijjar. Both countries expelled diplomats and froze consular services. The rifts stalled CEPA talks, slowed trade and delayed visa processing.

- PM Justin Trudeau alleged a potential link between Indian agents and Nijjar's killing in 2023.
- Both countries expelled diplomats and froze consular services.
- India sees Canada's tolerance of Khalistani separatist groups as a threat to territorial integrity.
- Diplomatic rifts stalled CEPA negotiations and slowed bilateral trade.
- Diplomatic rifts created uncertainty about Canadian investments in India.
- Delays in Canadian visa processing for Indians due to reduced Canadian diplomatic staff.
- The standoff may harm India's G20 reputation.
- The standoff may complicate relations with Five Eyes allies and a G7 member.

Mind-map outline

Diplomatic Strains

- Nijjar killing allegation (2023)
- Diplomatic response
  - Diplomats expelled
  - Consular services frozen
- Visa delays for Indians
- Trade impact
  - CEPA negotiations stalled
  - Uncertainty for Canadian investments

### **Khalistan Movement and Its Context**

The Khalistan movement is rooted in Sikh identity, the 1947 Partition and demands for Punjab's autonomy. Violent episodes such as the Air India bombing and the 1984 assassination of Indira Gandhi shaped the issue. Diaspora-based separatist support abroad keeps the issue alive in India-Canada ties.

- Khalsa tradition established in 1699, marking Sikh identity and autonomy.
- Partition of India (1947) left Sikhs as a minority, creating dissatisfaction over lost ancestral lands.
- Anandpur Sahib Resolution demanded greater autonomy for Punjab.
- Jarnail Singh Bhindranwale became the face of Sikh militancy, advocating Khalistan.
- Operation Black Thunder: Indian forces removed militants from the Golden Temple.
- Air India bombing: Canada-based Sikh extremists bombed a flight.
- In 1984, Indira Gandhi's Sikh bodyguards killed her, triggering anti-Sikh riots.
- Khalistani groups found support in Canada, the UK, the US and Australia.

Mind-map outline

Khalistan Issue

- Origins
  - Khalsa tradition (1699)

- Partition left Sikhs as minority (1947)
- Key events
  - Anandpur Sahib Resolution
  - Operation Black Thunder
  - Air India bombing
  - Indira Gandhi killed (1984)
- Impact on ties
  - Threat to territorial integrity (India view)
  - Support abroad in Canada, UK, US, Australia

## Vienna Conventions on Diplomatic Immunity

The Vienna Convention on Diplomatic Relations (1961) and the Vienna Convention on Consular Relations (1963) set the framework for diplomatic and consular ties. They protect diplomats from arrest and legal processes and make diplomatic missions inviolable. Consular officers can perform their duties without interference.

- Vienna Convention on Diplomatic Relations (1961) sets the framework for diplomatic relations.
- Vienna Convention on Consular Relations (1963) sets the framework for consular relations.
- Diplomats are protected from arrest and legal processes (diplomatic immunity).
- Missions cannot be entered without permission (inviolability of diplomatic premises).
- Consular officers can perform duties without interference.
- Diplomatic immunity is the key provision protecting diplomats.

Mnemonic - Diplomatic Immunity Protections: Diplomats Immune, Inviolable, Consuls Free  
 D = Diplomats are protected from arrest and legal processes; I = Inviolability: missions cannot be entered without permission; C = Consular officers can perform duties without interference

Mind-map outline

Vienna Conventions

- Diplomatic Relations (1961)
- Consular Relations (1963)
- Key provisions
  - Diplomats protected from arrest
  - Missions cannot be entered without permission
  - Consular officers act without interference

## National News and Issues

### Renaming Kerala as Keralam

#### Article 3 and the procedure to rename a State

Article 3 empowers Parliament to reorganise States, including changing the name of a State. The Union Cabinet approved renaming Kerala as Keralam under this Article. A renaming Bill needs the President's prior recommendation and is passed by simple majority, without a constitutional amendment.

- Article 3 empowers Parliament to reorganise States.
- Parliament can form a new State by separating territory from an existing State or by merging States or parts of States.
- Parliament can increase or diminish the area of a State, alter its boundaries or change its name.
- A Bill to rename a State can be introduced only with the prior recommendation of the President, which is mandatory.
- The President acts on the advice of the Union Government.
- The President refers the Bill to the concerned State Legislature.
- The State Legislature can express its views within a specified period.
- The opinion of the State Legislature is not binding.
- The Bill is passed by simple majority in both Houses of Parliament.
- No special majority or constitutional amendment is required.

Mnemonic - Powers under Article 3: FIDAC

F = Form a new State by separating territory or merging States; I = Increase the area of any State; D =

Diminish the area of any State; A = Alter the boundaries of any State; C = Change the name of any State

Mind-map outline

Article 3 and renaming a State

- Powers of Parliament
  - Form new State or merge States
  - Increase, diminish or alter area
  - Change name of a State
- Procedure steps
  - President's prior recommendation
  - Referred to State Legislature
  - Simple majority in both Houses

### **Articles 1, 2 and 4: Union, admission of States and status of such laws**

Articles 1 to 4 sit under Part I, which deals with the Union and its Territory. Article 1 describes India as a Union of States, and Article 2 empowers Parliament to admit or establish new States. Article 4 makes clear that laws under Articles 2 and 3 are not amendments under Article 368, so they can pass by simple majority.

- Articles 1 to 4 fall under Part I, titled Union and its Territory.
- India is called a Union even though its Constitution is federal in structure.
- Article 1 describes India, that is Bharat, as a Union of States rather than a Federation of States.
- Article 1 deals with two things: the name of the country and the type of polity.
- Article 2 empowers Parliament to admit into the Union, or establish, new States on terms it thinks fit.
- Admission under Article 2 refers to States already in existence; establishment refers to States not in existence before.
- Article 4 declares that laws made under Articles 2 and 3 are not amendments under Article 368.
- Such laws can therefore be passed by simple majority.
- Names of States and Union Territories and their territorial extent are in the First Schedule.
- At present, India has 28 States and 8 Union Territories.

Mnemonic - Articles 2, 3 and 4: Two-Three-Four: Simple majority, not amended

2 = Admission or establishment of new States; 3 = Renaming a State or altering its boundaries; 4 = Laws under 2 and 3 are not amendments under Article 368

Mind-map outline

Articles 1, 2 and 4

- Article 1
  - Union of States, not Federation
  - Name of country and type of polity
- Article 2
  - Admit States already in existence
  - Establish States not in existence
- Article 4
  - Laws under Articles 2 and 3
  - Not amendments under Article 368

### **Integration of Princely States and the 1950 classification**

At independence, India had British Provinces and Princely States. The Indian Independence Act (1947) gave Princely States three options, and 549 of 552 joined India. The Constitution of 1950 then classified the States and Territories into four parts.

- The Indian Independence Act (1947) created two independent dominions, India and Pakistan.
- The Act gave Princely States three options: join India, join Pakistan or remain independent.
- Of 552 Princely States within India's boundaries, 549 joined India.
- The three that refused were Hyderabad, Junagarh and Kashmir.
- Hyderabad was integrated by police action.
- Junagarh was integrated by means of a referendum.
- Kashmir was integrated by Instrument of Accession.
- Part A: 9 erstwhile Governor's Provinces of British India.

- Part B: 9 erstwhile Princely States with legislatures; Part C: erstwhile Chief Commissioner's Provinces and some Princely States.
- Andaman and Nicobar Islands were kept as a solitary Part D territory.

Mind-map outline

Princely States and 1950 classification

- Integration at independence
  - 549 of 552 joined India
  - Hyderabad: police action
  - Junagarh: referendum
  - Kashmir: Instrument of Accession
- 1950 four-part classification
  - Part A: 9 Governor's Provinces
  - Part B: 9 Princely States with legislatures
  - Part C: Chief Commissioner's Provinces
  - Part D: Andaman and Nicobar Islands

### **Linguistic reorganisation: commissions and the 1956 Act**

The demand for linguistic States led to several commissions. The Dhar Commission favoured administrative convenience, the JVP Committee rejected language as a basis, and the Fazl Ali Commission broadly accepted language. The States Reorganisation Act (1956) then created 14 States and 6 Union Territories on 1 November 1956.

- The Dhar Commission (June 1948), chaired by SK Dhar, examined reorganisation on the linguistic factor.
- The Dhar Commission recommended administrative convenience rather than the linguistic factor.
- The JVP Committee (Dec 1948) consisted of Jawaharlal Nehru, Vallabhbhai Patel and Pattabhi Sitaramayya.
- The JVP Committee formally rejected language as the basis for reorganisation of States.
- The Fazl Ali Commission, a 3-member body, was appointed to re-examine the question in December 1953.
- The Fazl Ali Commission broadly accepted language as the basis but rejected One Language - One State.
- The Fazl Ali Commission suggested 16 States and 3 Centrally Administered Territories.
- The States Reorganisation Act (1956) and a related amendment created 14 States and 6 Union Territories on 1 November 1956.
- Andhra State (1953) was created by separating Telugu-speaking areas from Madras State.

Mnemonic - Commission sequence: DJF: Dhar, JVP, then Fazl Ali

D = Dhar Commission (1948) favoured administrative convenience; J = JVP Committee (1948-49) rejected language as the basis; F = Fazl Ali Commission (report 1955) broadly accepted language

Mind-map outline

Linguistic reorganisation debate

- Commissions and committees
  - Dhar Commission: administrative convenience
  - JVP Committee: rejected language basis
  - Fazl Ali Commission: broadly accepted language
- Outcome
  - Andhra State created in 1953
  - States Reorganisation Act 1956
  - 14 States and 6 UTs on 1 Nov 1956

### **SC Ruling on Creamy Layer Determination for OBCs**

## 2026 SC ruling on creamy layer

In March 2026 the Supreme Court ruled that parental income alone cannot be the sole criterion for determining creamy layer status of OBCs. The Court found that children of government employees are assessed by parental rank or post, while children of PSU and private-sector employees are assessed mainly on parental income, and called this unequal. The Court favoured a post-based criterion across all sectors, while critics point to the absence of a uniform private-sector hierarchy and to the role of income in access to opportunities.

- Supreme Court ruled parental income alone cannot be the sole criterion for creamy layer status of OBCs (March 2026).
- Creamy layer principle excludes socially and economically advanced OBC members from reservation benefits.
- Children of government employees are evaluated on parental rank or post.
- Children of PSU and private-sector employees are assessed primarily on parental income.
- The Court called this unequal method inconsistent and a violation of the principle of equality.
- Court proposed a post-based criterion (Group A, B, C or D) as the primary factor for PSU and private-sector parents.
- Rank or position in employment reflects social status and influence better than income alone.
- Critics: private sector lacks a uniform rank hierarchy, making post-based classification difficult.
- Critics: high-income private-sector families could retain reservation benefits.

Mind-map outline

SC ruling on creamy layer

- Core holding
  - Parental income not sole criterion
  - Applies to OBC creamy layer
- Unequal assessment
  - Govt employees: parental rank or post
  - PSU and private: parental income
- Reasoning
  - Rank reflects social status
  - Long service may not raise status
- Criticisms
  - No uniform private-sector hierarchy
  - High-income families may keep benefits

## Early history of caste-based reservation

The idea of caste-based reservation was first proposed in 1882, and separate electorates appeared under the 1909 Act. The 1951 First Amendment added Article 15(4) to legalise caste-based reservation, after the Champakam Dorairajan case had held such reservations violated Article 15. The 1953 Kalelkar Commission and the 1963 MR Balaji ruling, which kept reservation at 50%, shaped the early framework.

- 1882: caste-based reservation first proposed by William Hunter and Jyotirao Phule.
- 1909: Government of India Act gave elements of reservation through separate electorates.
- 1932: MacDonald/Communal Award provided separate electorates for Depressed Classes.
- Poona Pact abandoned separate electorates for Depressed Classes.
- 1935: Government of India Act extended separate electorates to Depressed Classes, Women and Labour.
- 1951: First Constitutional Amendment added Article 15(4).
- Champakam Dorairajan vs State of Madras (1951): caste-based reservations held to violate Article 15.
- 1953: Kalelkar Commission (first Backward Class Commission) identified backward classes other than SCs and STs at national level.
- 1963: MR Balaji vs State of Mysore: Government ordered to keep reservation at 50%.

Mind-map outline

Early reservation history

- Pre-independence
  - 1882: Hunter and Phule proposal
  - 1909: separate electorates

- 1932: MacDonald Award
- Poona Pact abandoned separate electorates
- 1935: communal representation extended
- Post-independence
  - 1951: Article 15(4) added
  - 1951: Champakam case against caste quotas
  - 1953: Kalelkar Commission
  - 1963: MR Balaji 50% cap

### **Mandal Commission and Indra Sawhney case**

In 1979 the Morarji Desai government appointed the second Backward Classes Commission under Article 340, and its 1980 report identified 3,743 castes and recommended 27% reservation in government jobs for OBCs. That recommendation was implemented in 1990, and in 1991 economic criteria were introduced along with a further 10% for poorer higher castes. The Indra Sawhney judgement of 1992 rejected the 10% but upheld the 27% OBC quota with conditions.

- 1979: Morarji Desai government appointed the second Backward Classes Commission under Article 340.
- The commission was headed by BP Mandal and submitted its report in 1980.
- Identified 3,743 castes as socially and educationally backward.
- Recommended 27% reservation in government jobs for OBCs.
- 1990: 27% OBC reservation implemented by the VP Singh government.
- 1991: preference to poorer OBC sections and 10% reservation for economically backward higher castes.
- Indra Sawhney (1992): the extra 10% for higher castes was rejected; 27% OBC reservation was upheld with conditions.
- Conditions: total reservation shall not exceed 50%; reservation in promotions not allowed.
- Creamy layer introduced and to be excluded while identifying Backward Classes; carry-forward rule for backlog vacancies valid.
- A permanent statutory body should examine complaints of over- and under-inclusion in the OBC list.

Mnemonic - Indra Sawhney 1992 conditions: Five Pots Can Cook Breakfast

F = Fifty: total reservation cannot exceed 50%; P = Promotions: no reservation in promotions; C = Creamy layer: introduced and excluded from backward class identification; C = Carry forward: rule for unfilled backlog vacancies is valid; B = Body: permanent statutory body to examine inclusion complaints

Mind-map outline

Mandal Commission and Indra Sawhney

- Commission (1979-1980)
  - Morarji Desai government, 1979
  - Set up under Article 340
  - 3,743 castes identified
  - Report submitted 1980
- Recommendations
  - 27% govt jobs for OBCs
  - Implemented 1990
  - 1991: 10% for poorer higher castes
- Indra Sawhney 1992
  - 27% upheld, 10% rejected
  - Cap of 50% total reservation
  - No reservation in promotions
  - Creamy layer introduced

### **Later judgements and economic reservation**

Later judgements clarified rules on promotions, the 9th Schedule and creamy layer exclusion for SCs and STs. The 103rd Constitutional Amendment of 2019 introduced 10% reservation for EWS, and the 2022 Janhit Abhiyan judgement upheld it. The 106th Amendment Act of 2023 provides one-third reservation for women in Parliament and State Legislatures, which ceases after 15 years.

- 2006 Nagaraj case: State not bound to provide reservation in promotions to SCs and STs.

- To make such a provision, a State must collect quantifiable data, prove inadequate representation and show no compromise on efficiency.
- 2007 IR Coelho case: laws placed in the 9th Schedule after 24 April 1973 are subject to judicial review.
- Tamil Nadu's 69% reservation policy was placed in the 9th Schedule in 1994 by the 76th Amendment Act.
- 2018 Jarnail Singh case: creamy layer exclusion extends to SCs and STs.
- 2018 Jarnail Singh case: reservation in promotions does not require quantifiable data on SC/ST backwardness.
- 103rd Constitutional Amendment (2019) provided 10% reservation for Economically Weaker Sections (EWS).
- EWS reservation was based on a commission for Economically Backward Classes (constituted 2005, report July 2010).
- 2022 Janhit Abhiyan vs Union of India: 103rd Amendment upheld.
- 106th Amendment Act (2023): one-third of seats for women in Parliament and State Legislatures; ceases after 15 years.

Mind-map outline

Later judgements and economic reservation

- Judicial rulings
  - 2006 Nagaraj: promotions not mandatory
  - 2007 IR Coelho: 9th Schedule review
  - 2018 Jarnail Singh: SC/ST creamy layer
  - 2022 Janhit Abhiyan upheld EWS
- Economic reservation
  - 103rd Amendment 2019: 10% EWS
  - EWS commission report July 2010
- Other reforms
  - TN 69% under 9th Schedule, 1994
  - 106th Amendment: one-third women seats

## National Commission for Backward Classes

The National Commission for Backward Classes was set up in 1993 by an Act of Parliament. The 102nd Constitutional Amendment Act of 2018 gave it constitutional status under Article 338B and widened its functions. It consists of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other members, appointed by the President.

- Set up in 1993 by an Act of Parliament.
- 102nd Constitutional Amendment Act 2018 gave constitutional status to the NCBC.
- Article 338B provided constitutional status to the NCBC and increased the scope of its functions.
- NCBC is authorised to investigate complaints and welfare of backward classes.
- Article 342A empowers the President to specify socially and educationally backward classes in States and UTs.
- Composition: Chairperson, Vice-Chairperson and 3 other members.
- Members are appointed by the President by warrant under his hand and seal.
- Conditions of service and tenure are determined by the President.
- NCBC can recommend inclusion and exclusion of castes from the OBC list.
- NCBC can recommend the income level that excludes the creamy layer from reservation benefits.

Mnemonic - NCBC milestones: Ninety-three made it, Eighteen made it constitutional  
 1993 = NCBC set up by an Act of Parliament; 2018 = 102nd Amendment gave NCBC constitutional status

Mind-map outline

National Commission for Backward Classes

- Establishment
  - Set up 1993 by Act of Parliament
  - 102nd Amendment 2018 gave status
- Composition
  - Chairperson
  - Vice-Chairperson
  - 3 other members

- Appointed by President by warrant
- Functions
  - Recommend OBC list inclusion or exclusion
  - Recommend creamy layer income level
  - Investigate complaints and welfare
- Articles
  - Article 338B: NCBC status
  - Article 342A: President specifies classes

## Polity & Governance

### Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Amendment Bill, 2026

#### Definition and Certification Changes

The Bill narrows the definition of transgender person and omits Section 4(2) of the 2019 Act, which had recognised a person's right to self-perceived gender identity. Identity would be verified by a Medical Board led by a Chief Medical Officer or Deputy CMO, and the District Magistrate would issue the certificate on the Board's recommendation. Individuals who undergo gender reassignment surgery must apply for a revised gender certificate.

- Bill omits Section 4(2) of the Transgender Persons Act, 2019.
- Section 4(2) earlier recognised the right to self-perceived gender identity.
- Definition keeps socio-cultural identities: Kinner, Hijra, Aravani, Jogta, Eunuch.
- Definition covers specified inter-sex variations.
- Definition covers congenital variations in sexual traits (genitalia, chromosomes, hormones).
- Definition covers persons forced into transgender identity through mutilation or castration.
- Removed categories: Trans-Man, Trans-Woman, Genderqueer.
- Medical Board led by CMO or Deputy CMO verifies transgender identity.
- District Magistrate issues certificate based on the Board's recommendation.
- Gender reassignment surgery requires a revised gender certificate application.

Mnemonic - Socio-cultural identities in the definition: Kind Hearts Always Joke Easily

K = Kinner: socio-cultural identity in the definition; H = Hijra: socio-cultural identity in the definition; A = Aravani: socio-cultural identity in the definition; J = Jogta: socio-cultural identity in the definition; E = Eunuch: socio-cultural identity in the definition

Mind-map outline

Definition and Certification

- Definition
  - Section 4(2) omitted
  - Trans-Man, Trans-Woman, Genderqueer removed
- Certification
  - Medical Board led by CMO or Deputy CMO
  - DM issues certificate
- Revision
  - Revised gender certificate after surgery

#### Penal, Reporting and National Council Provisions

The Bill expands penal provisions, with life imprisonment for forced mutilation of minors and up to 14 years for forcing children into begging. Medical institutions must report gender-affirming surgeries to the District Magistrate, and certificate holders can change their name in official documents. The National Council for Transgender Persons will include State and UT representatives, with rotational representation across regions.

- Life imprisonment for forced mutilation of minors.
- Up to 14 years imprisonment for forcing children into begging.
- Medical institutions must report gender-affirming surgeries to the District Magistrate.
- Certificate holders can change their name in official documents.
- National Council to include State and UT representatives.
- Representation on the National Council is rotational across regions.

- Council members must be of Director rank or above.
- Council members are nominated by the Centre Govt.

Mnemonic - National Council composition: Directors Rotate, Centre Chooses

D = Members must be of Director rank or above; R = Representation is rotational across regions; C = Members are nominated by the Centre Govt

Mind-map outline

Penal, Reporting and Council

- Penal provisions
  - Life imprisonment for forced mutilation of minors
  - Up to 14 years for forcing children into begging
- Reporting
  - Medical institutions report to District Magistrate
- Name change
  - Certificate holders change official documents
- National Council
  - State and UT representatives
  - Rotational across regions
  - Director rank or above, nominated by Centre

## Significance and Criticism

Supporters say the narrower definition and medical certification target welfare, reduce the discretionary power of District Magistrates, and support a national healthcare database. Critics argue that removing self-identification contradicts the NALSA judgment, that medical verification may pathologise gender identity, and that surgery reporting may affect privacy. They also warn that broad terms could be used against NGOs and healthcare providers.

- Narrow definition aims to ensure benefits reach the most marginalised communities.
- Medical Boards reduce the discretionary power of District Magistrates.
- Mandatory reporting enables a national database for healthcare planning and welfare schemes.
- Penal framework addresses mutilation, abduction and forced identity.
- Removal of self-identification contradicts NALSA vs Union of India (2014).
- NALSA judgment recognised gender identity as a Fundamental Right under Article 21.
- Medical Board verification may pathologise gender identity.
- Mandatory reporting of surgeries may violate medical confidentiality and personal privacy.
- Broad terms like 'Inducement' or 'Allurement' could be used against NGOs and healthcare providers.
- Such terms may restrict voluntary gender transition support.

Mind-map outline

Significance and Criticism

- Significance
  - Targeted welfare for marginalised communities
  - Medical Boards reduce DM discretion
  - National database for healthcare planning
- Criticism
  - Contradicts NALSA self-identification
  - May pathologise gender identity
  - Privacy and medical confidentiality
  - Terms may be used against NGOs

## Legal and Welfare Background

Legal recognition of transgender persons in India developed through Supreme Court judgments and the 2019 Act. The NALSA judgment (2014) granted legal recognition and rights, and the 2019 Act provides legal recognition, protection of rights and welfare. Government initiatives include the SMILE scheme, a National Portal for ID cards and certificates, and Garima Greh shelter homes.

- NALSA vs Union of India (2014) granted legal recognition and rights to transgender persons.
- Justice K.S. Puttaswamy vs Union of India (2017): Supreme Court ruled privacy a fundamental right.
- Navtej Singh Johar vs Union of India (2018): Section 377 struck down, decriminalising same-sex relationships.
- Transgender Persons Act, 2019 grants legal recognition and prohibits discrimination.

- Supriyo vs Union of India (2023): a 5-Judge Constitution Bench rejected petitions to legalise same-sex marriage.
- SMILE scheme provides comprehensive rehabilitation and medical cover for marginalised individuals.
- National Portal lets transgender persons apply for ID cards and certificates without physical visits to offices.
- Garima Greh: government shelter homes offering safe spaces, food and skill development for transgender persons in distress.

Mind-map outline

Legal and Welfare Background

- Judicial milestones
  - NALSA (2014): legal recognition and rights
  - Puttaswamy (2017): privacy a fundamental right
  - Navtej (2018): Section 377 struck down
  - Supriyo (2023): same-sex marriage petitions rejected
- Statute
  - Transgender Persons Act 2019: no discrimination
- Welfare initiatives
  - SMILE: rehabilitation and medical cover
  - National Portal: ID cards and certificates
  - Garima Greh: shelter for persons in distress

## Economics

### New GDP Series with Base Year Revised to 2022-23

#### Base Year Revision to 2022-23

The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation released the New National Accounts Series, with the GDP base year revised from 2011-12 to 2022-23. The 2026 revision is the 8th base year revision since 1948-49 and aligns with System of National Accounts 2008 and the IMF Quarterly National Accounts Manual 2017. A base year is the benchmark for measuring real changes in GDP, CPI and IIP over time. Revisions reflect structural changes in the economy, such as digital services expansion, renewable energy growth and changing consumption patterns.

- Released by Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (Rao Inderjit Singh)
- New base year is 2022-23; earlier base year was 2011-12
- 2026 revision is the 8th base year revision since 1948-49
- Before 2026, the base year was last updated to 2011-12 in 2015
- A base year removes the inflation effect and enables accurate index creation
- A base year reflects current economic structure, consumption patterns and price trends
- The revision aligns with SNA 2008 and IMF QNA Manual 2017
- 2022-23 was chosen as the most recent normal economic year after COVID-19 disruptions
- Periodic revision follows guidelines of the United Nations Statistical Commission

Mnemonic - Three reasons for base year revision: SAC: Structure, Alignment, Credibility

S = Reflects structural economic changes such as digital services and renewable energy; A = Aligns with international standards; C = Improves accuracy and credibility of GDP

Mind-map outline

Base year revision 2022-23

- Benchmark for comparing indicators
  - Removes inflation effect
  - Enables accurate index creation
  - Reflects current economic structure
- Why revision is needed
  - Structural economic changes
  - Alignment with international standards
  - Accuracy and credibility
- Key changes
  - New base year 2022-23
  - Earlier base year 2011-12

- 2026 is 8th revision since 1948-49

## Improved Data Sources and Methods

The new series integrates high-frequency and administrative datasets, including GST collection, vehicle registration data, PFMS, the Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises and the Periodic Labour Force Survey. Double deflation adjusts both output prices and input prices, giving a more accurate measure of real value addition in manufacturing and agriculture. The revision brings the National Pension System and the Old Pension Scheme into government sector accounting. Platform workers, digital economy participants and hired domestic workers are now captured.

- GST collection data is one of the new high-frequency and administrative datasets
- Vehicle registration data and PFMS are integrated into the new series
- Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises and Periodic Labour Force Survey are new data sources
- Improves coverage of the informal sector, gig economy, household enterprises and digital activities
- Earlier single deflation adjusted only output prices
- Double deflation adjusts both output prices and input prices
- Double deflation gives more accurate real value addition in manufacturing and agriculture
- GDP now includes the National Pension System and the Old Pension Scheme
- Captures platform workers, digital economy participants and hired domestic workers

Mind-map outline

Improved data and methods

- Data sources
  - GST collection data
  - Vehicle registration data
  - PFMS and Periodic Labour Force Survey
- Double deflation
  - Adjusts output prices
  - Adjusts input prices
  - More accurate real value addition
- Wider coverage
  - National Pension System and Old Pension Scheme
  - Gig and platform workers
  - Hired domestic workers

## GDP Concepts and Measurement

GDP is the total monetary value of all finished goods and services produced. It can be calculated by three methods: expenditure, production and income. On the expenditure side, GDP equals consumption plus investment plus government expenditure plus exports minus imports. Real GDP is inflation-adjusted GDP, while nominal GDP is GDP at current prices.

- GDP is the total monetary value of all finished goods and services produced
- Three methods to calculate GDP: expenditure, production and income
- Expenditure formula:  $GDP = C + I + G + (X - M)$
- C is goods and services consumed; I is investments; G is government expenditures
- Real GDP is inflation-adjusted GDP
- Nominal GDP is GDP at current prices
- GDP at factor cost = GDP at market prices + subsidies - indirect taxes
- GDP at market prices is the measure of GDP in India
- GDP is not an accurate measure of the overall living standard or well-being of a country
- Example: 2021 GDP at current prices Rs 1000; 2022 GDP at current prices Rs 1650; 2022 real GDP at 2021 prices Rs 1100

Mnemonic - Three methods to calculate GDP: Eat Pizza Immediately

E = Expenditure method; P = Production method; I = Income method

Mind-map outline

GDP concepts and measurement

- Definition
  - Total monetary value of finished output
  - Goods and services produced
- Three methods
  - Expenditure method
  - Production method
  - Income method
- Expenditure formula
  - $C + I + G + (X - M)$
- Price measures
  - Real GDP: inflation-adjusted
  - Nominal GDP: current prices
  - GDP at FC = GDP at MP + subsidies - indirect taxes

### **Economic Implications of the Revision**

Real GDP growth is revised upward to 7.6% for FY 2025-26, while nominal GDP is lower at 345.47 lakh crore. Lower nominal GDP can raise the fiscal deficit and debt-to-GDP ratios even though absolute deficit levels are unchanged. Sectoral growth in FY26 is 2.8% in the primary, 9.5% in the secondary and 8.9% in the tertiary sector. More accurate economic data supports policy formulation, investment and business planning.

- Real GDP growth revised upward to 7.6% for FY 2025-26
- Nominal GDP for FY 2025-26 is 345.47 lakh crore after revision
- Fiscal deficit (as % of GDP): revised 4.51%, earlier 4.36%
- Debt-to-GDP ratio: revised estimate 57.5% for FY 2026-27, earlier target 55.6%
- Lower nominal GDP can raise fiscal deficit and debt-to-GDP ratios despite unchanged absolute deficit levels
- Primary sector growth in FY26 is 2.8%, from 5% in FY25
- Secondary sector growth in FY26 is 9.5%, from 7.3% in FY25
- Tertiary sector growth in FY26 is 8.9%, from 8.3% in FY25
- More accurate economic data supports policy formulation, investment and business decisions

Mind-map outline

Economic implications

- Growth
  - Real GDP growth 7.6% for FY 2025-26
  - Nominal GDP 345.47 lakh crore
- Fiscal indicators
  - Fiscal deficit 4.51% (earlier 4.36%)
  - Debt-to-GDP 57.5% (earlier 55.6%)
- Sectoral growth FY26
  - Primary 2.8% (FY25: 5%)
  - Secondary 9.5% (FY25: 7.3%)
  - Tertiary 8.9% (FY25: 8.3%)

## **Reports, Summits, Indices**

### **World Happiness Report 2026**

#### **Report basics and International Day of Happiness**

The World Happiness Report is published annually by the Wellbeing Research Centre at the University of Oxford, in collaboration with Gallup and the UN Sustainable Development Solutions Network. Participants rate their lives on a scale of 0 to 10, and the report uses six key indicators. The 2026 edition was released on the International Day of Happiness, which is observed on 20 March and coincides with the vernal equinox.

- 2026 is the 14th edition of the World Happiness Report
- Published annually since 2012
- Published by the Wellbeing Research Centre, University of Oxford
- Prepared in collaboration with Gallup and UN SDSN

- Participants rate their lives on a scale of 0 to 10
- Six key indicators: GDP per capita, social support, healthy life expectancy, freedom, generosity, perception of corruption
- Report helps countries assess development beyond GDP
- International Day of Happiness observed on 20 March
- Day coincides with the vernal equinox
- Theme of International Day of Happiness 2026: Care and Share
- Day was pioneered by Bhutan, which prioritised Gross National Happiness over GDP

Mnemonic - International Day of Happiness: Bhutan's Equal Twenty

Bhutan = Pioneered the concept behind the day, Gross National Happiness; Equal = Day coincides with the vernal equinox, when day and night are of approximately equal length; Twenty = Day is observed annually on 20 March

Mind-map outline

Report and International Day

- Report
  - Oxford Wellbeing Research Centre
  - Gallup and UN SDSN collaboration
  - Published annually since 2012
  - Self-rating scale: 0 to 10
- Day
  - Observed 20 March
  - Coincides with vernal equinox
  - Theme 2026: Care and Share
  - Pioneered by Bhutan

## Global rankings 2026

Finland ranked first in the 2026 report, its ninth consecutive year at the top, with Iceland and Denmark following. Costa Rica rose to 4th place from 23rd, while Afghanistan ranked lowest at 147th. No Anglosphere nation appeared in the top 10 for a second consecutive year, which the report links to a shift in global happiness rankings.

- Finland: rank 1, score 7.764, 9th consecutive year at rank 1
- Iceland and Denmark follow Finland in the top ranks
- Costa Rica: rank 4, moved up from 23rd
- Afghanistan: lowest ranked at 147th
- Sierra Leone and Malawi follow Afghanistan at the bottom
- No Anglosphere nation in the top 10 for 2nd consecutive year
- New Zealand 11th, Ireland 13th, Australia 15th
- USA 23rd, Canada 25th, UK 29th
- Costa Rica's strong social cohesion is cited among its gains

Mind-map outline

Global rankings 2026

- Top
  - Finland rank 1, 9th straight year
  - Iceland and Denmark follow
- Costa Rica rise
  - Rank 4, from 23rd
- Bottom
  - Afghanistan rank 147
  - Sierra Leone and Malawi follow
- Anglosphere
  - No top 10 place, 2nd straight year
  - New Zealand 11th, Ireland 13th, Australia 15th
  - USA 23rd, Canada 25th, UK 29th

## India and BRICS comparison

India ranked 116th in the 2026 report with a score of 4.536, improved from 118th. Its areas of improvement were social support and healthy life expectancy. Among BRICS nations, China ranked highest at 65th, and India ranked below Nepal and Pakistan but above Bangladesh and Sri Lanka.

- India: rank 116th, score 4.536
- India improved from 118th in the previous ranking
- India's areas of improvement: social support and healthy life expectancy
- China ranked 65th, the highest among BRICS nations
- India ranked below Nepal (99th) and Pakistan (104th)
- India ranked above Bangladesh (127th) and Sri Lanka (134th)

Mind-map outline

India and BRICS

- India
  - Rank 116th, score 4.536
  - Up from 118th
  - Improved: social support, healthy life expectancy
- BRICS
  - China highest at 65th
- Regional comparison
  - Below Nepal (99th) and Pakistan (104th)
  - Above Bangladesh (127th) and Sri Lanka (134th)

## Social media and youth well-being

The 2026 report examines how social media use relates to happiness among young people. Youth aged 15 to 24 report lower life satisfaction than those aged 60 and above, a pattern seen in the United States, Canada, Australia and New Zealand. Adolescent girls using social media for more than five hours a day are the most vulnerable group, while youth using it for under one hour a day report the best well-being.

- Youth aged 15-24 report lower life satisfaction than elderly aged 60+
- Age-based pattern observed in US, Canada, Australia and New Zealand
- Most vulnerable group: adolescent girls using social media over 5 hours a day
- Heavy use linked with decline in mental health and comparison-driven stress
- Optimal threshold: youth using social media under 1 hour a day
- Youth using under 1 hour a day report even better well-being than non-users
- Digital paradox: in developing countries like India, digital access improves education and connectivity
- Excessive use in the same settings causes stress and anxiety
- Report provides insights into mental health and digital behaviour trends

Mnemonic - Social media thresholds: Under One Thrives, Over Five Struggles

Under One = Youth using social media under 1 hour a day report the best well-being; Over Five = Adolescent girls using social media over 5 hours a day are the most vulnerable group

Mind-map outline

Social media and youth

- Age trend
  - Youth 15-24 lower satisfaction than 60+
  - Seen in US, Canada, Australia, NZ
- Vulnerable group
  - Adolescent girls over 5 hours/day
- Optimal use
  - Under 1 hour/day
  - Better than non-users
- Digital paradox
  - Access aids education and connectivity
  - Excess use brings stress and anxiety

## Science & Technology, Defence and Space

## **SIPRI Report: India as 2nd Largest Arms Importer**

### **SIPRI and global arms transfers**

The Stockholm International Peace Research Institute (SIPRI), an independent research institute, released the Trends in International Arms Transfers 2025 report on global defence trade. International arms transfers rose 9.2% in 2021-25 compared with 2016-20. The rise in European arms imports, up 210%, was largely driven by the Russia-Ukraine war.

- SIPRI: Stockholm International Peace Research Institute, established 1966
- SIPRI headquarters: Stockholm, Sweden
- SIPRI focus areas: Conflict and Peace Studies; Armaments and Military Expenditure; Arms Transfers and Disarmament
- International arms transfers rose 9.2% (2021-25 vs 2016-20)
- Arms imports by European countries rose 210%
- Rise in European imports largely driven by the Russia-Ukraine war

Mnemonic - SIPRI focus areas: CAT

C = Conflict and Peace Studies; A = Armaments and Military Expenditure; T = Arms Transfers and Disarmament

Mind-map outline

SIPRI global arms transfer findings

- SIPRI profile
  - Established 1966, HQ Stockholm
  - Independent research institute
- 2021-25 trends
  - Transfers up 9.2%
  - European imports up 210%
- Main driver
  - Russia-Ukraine war

### **Top global exporters and importers**

The SIPRI report ranks the largest arms exporters and importers for 2021-25. The United States led exports with a 42% share, while Ukraine topped imports with a 9.7% share. Russia's arms exports fell sharply, cutting its share of global exports.

- Top exporter: United States, 42% share
- Next exporters in order: France, Russia, Germany, China
- Russia's arms exports declined by 64%
- Russia's share of global exports fell to 6.8%
- Top importer: Ukraine, 9.7% share
- India ranked second among importers, with an 8.2% share

Mind-map outline

Top global exporters and importers

- Exporters
  - United States: 42%
  - Then France, Russia, Germany, China
  - Russia's exports down 64%
- Importers
  - Ukraine: 9.7%
  - India second: 8.2%

### **India as 2nd largest arms importer**

India remained the second-largest arms importer during 2021-25, with an 8.2% share. Its overall arms imports fell by 4%, largely due to increased domestic defence manufacturing and indigenisation. Russia, France and Israel were its main suppliers.

- India's import rank in 2021-25: 2nd largest
- India's share of global arms imports: 8.2%
- India's overall arms imports declined by 4%
- Decline largely due to domestic manufacturing and indigenisation efforts

- India's supplier composition: Russia 40%
- India's supplier composition: France 29%
- India's supplier composition: Israel 15%

Mnemonic - India's main arms suppliers: Really Fine Imports

R = Russia supplies 40% of India's arms imports; F = France supplies 29% of India's arms imports; I = Israel supplies 15% of India's arms imports

Mind-map outline

India's arms import position

- Rank and share
  - 2nd largest importer
  - Share 8.2%
- Imports down 4%
  - Domestic manufacturing
  - Indigenisation efforts
- Suppliers
  - Russia 40%
  - France 29%
  - Israel 15%

## India's push for domestic defence

India has set production and export targets for 2029 and is building its domestic defence capacity. Policy changes, defence industrial corridors and foreign investment rules support this aim. The top three export destinations are the US, France and Armenia.

- Defence budget 2026-27: Rs 7.85 lakh crore
- Defence production 2024-25: Rs 1.54 lakh crore (2029 target: Rs 3 lakh crore)
- Defence exports 2024-25: Rs 23,622 crore (2029 target: Rs 50,000 crore)
- Top 3 export destinations: US, France, Armenia
- Defence Acquisition Procedure 2020 prioritises Indian-made products over foreign purchases
- Defence Industrial Corridors established in Uttar Pradesh and Tamil Nadu
- FDI: 74% through automatic route; 100% through government route
- iDEX supports startups and MSMEs in defence innovation

Mind-map outline

India's domestic defence push

- Budget and output
  - Budget 2026-27: Rs 7.85 lakh crore
  - Production 2024-25: Rs 1.54 lakh crore
- Exports
  - 2024-25: Rs 23,622 crore
  - 2029 target: Rs 50,000 crore
- Policy and ecosystem
  - DAP 2020: Indian-made products first
  - Corridors: UP and Tamil Nadu
  - FDI: 74% automatic, 100% government
  - iDEX for startups and MSMEs

## Sports, Awards & Days

### Winter Olympic Games (Milano Cortina 2026)

#### Milano Cortina 2026 Edition

The 25th Winter Olympic Games were held from 6 to 22 February 2026 in Italy, with Milan and Cortina d'Ampezzo as joint hosts. It was the first joint two-city Winter Olympics and Italy's fourth time hosting an Olympic Games. The Opening Ceremony was at the San Siro Stadium in Milan and the Closing Ceremony at the Verona Arena.

- 25th Winter Olympic Games held 6-22 February 2026
- Hosts: Milan and Cortina d'Ampezzo, Italy
- First joint two-city Winter Olympics

- Italy's fourth time hosting an Olympic Games
- Earlier Italian hosting: Cortina 1956 (Winter), Rome 1960 (Summer), Turin 2006 (Winter)
- Opening Ceremony: San Siro Stadium, Milan
- Closing Ceremony: Verona Arena
- Official motto: 'IT's Your Vibe'
- Mascots: Tina and Milo (white stoats)
- Theme 'Armonia' (Harmony); 16 winter sports, debut sport Ski Mountaineering (Skimo)

Mnemonic - Italy's earlier Olympic hosting: Can Rest Tonight

C = Cortina 1956 (Winter Games); R = Rome 1960 (Summer Games); T = Turin 2006 (Winter Games)

Mind-map outline

Milano Cortina 2026 edition

- Hosts and dates
  - Milan and Cortina d'Ampezzo
  - 6-22 February 2026
- Ceremonies
  - Opening: San Siro Stadium
  - Closing: Verona Arena
- Symbols
  - Motto: IT's Your Vibe
  - Theme: Armonia
  - Mascots: Tina and Milo
- Sports
  - 16 winter sports
  - Debut: Ski Mountaineering (Skimo)

## Medal Tally and Participation

Norway topped the final medal table for the fourth consecutive time, with 41 medals including 18 gold. The USA (33 medals, 12 gold) and the Netherlands (20 medals, 10 gold) followed, and host Italy won 30 medals. India sent two athletes, who won no medals, and Abhinav Bindra was India's torchbearer.

- Norway: 41 medals, 18 gold; topped the final table
- Norway topped the final medal table for the 4th consecutive time
- USA: 33 medals, 12 gold
- Netherlands: 20 medals, 10 gold
- Italy: 30 medals (10 gold, 6 silver, 14 bronze)
- India fielded 2 athletes and won no medals
- Arif Mohammad Khan: Alpine Skiing, Men's Slalom
- Stanzin Lunduo: Cross-Country Skiing
- India's torchbearer: Abhinav Bindra, India's 1st individual Olympic gold medallist

Mind-map outline

Medal tally and participation

- Top medal winners
  - Norway: 41 medals, 18 gold
  - USA: 33 medals, 12 gold
  - Netherlands: 20 medals, 10 gold
- Host Italy
  - 30 medals
  - 10 gold, 6 silver, 14 bronze
- India
  - 2 athletes, no medals
  - Torchbearer: Abhinav Bindra

## History of the Olympic Games

The ancient Olympic Games started in 776 BCE at Olympia, Greece, and the record of the last ancient Games is found in 261 AD. Baron Pierre de Coubertin founded the modern Olympics, and the first modern international event was held at Athens in 1896. Women first took part at the 1900 Paris Olympics, the same year India first participated.

- Ancient Olympic Games started in 776 BCE at Olympia, Greece
- In 393 AD, Theodosius I banned the Olympics along with Greek temples and god statues
- Record of the last ancient Olympic Games found in 261 AD
- Founder of the modern Olympics: Baron Pierre de Coubertin
- First modern international Olympic event: Athens, 1896
- Women first took part at the 1900 Paris Olympics; Margaret Abbott (Golf) became the first female Olympic champion
- 2020 Olympics postponed to 2021 due to COVID-19 restrictions
- Olympics cancelled due to WWI: Berlin (1916)
- India first participated in 1900, first sent a Summer team in 1920, and competed at Innsbruck (Austria) Winter Games in 1964
- Norman Pritchard, a lone athlete, won 2 silver medals in athletics

Mind-map outline

History of the Olympic Games

- Ancient Games
  - Started 776 BCE, Olympia
  - Banned in 393 AD by Theodosius I
- Modern Games
  - Founder: Pierre de Coubertin
  - First event: Athens 1896
- Firsts
  - Women first took part in 1900 Paris
  - India first participated in 1900

## Olympic Bodies and India's Sports Schemes

The International Olympic Committee, established in 1894, is headquartered in Lausanne, Switzerland, and its President is Kirsty Coventry. In India, the Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports is the nodal ministry, supported by schemes such as TOPS (2014), Khelo India (2017), Fit India (2019) and KIRTI (2024). A WADA 2023 report placed India high on banned-substance positivity among major nations.

- IOC: established 1894, headquarters in Lausanne, Switzerland
- IOC President: Kirsty Coventry
- IOC motto: Citius, Altius, Fortius (Faster, Higher, Stronger)
- Indian Olympic Association: set up 1927, President PT Usha, HQ New Delhi
- Nodal ministry: Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports
- TOPS (2014): identifies and supports athletes with potential to win Olympic medals
- Khelo India (2017): identification and development of athletes at grassroots and elite levels
- Fit India Movement (2019): mass participation in fitness activities
- KIRTI Programme (2024): talent hunt among school children aged 9 to 18
- WADA 2023 report: India had the highest positivity rate for banned substances among major nations

Mnemonic - India's sports schemes: Fit Kids Kick Talent

F = Fit India Movement (2019); K = Khelo India (2017); K = KIRTI Programme (2024); T = TOPS (2014), which identifies and supports medal-potential athletes

Mind-map outline

Olympic bodies and India's schemes

- IOC
  - Established 1894, Lausanne
  - President: Kirsty Coventry
- India's schemes
  - TOPS (2014)

- Khelo India (2017)
- Fit India (2019)
- KIRTI (2024)
- Anti-doping
  - WADA 2023 report
  - Highest positivity rate among major nations

## World Tuberculosis Day 2026

### Global burden and progress

The Global TB Report 2025 shows that a small group of countries carries most of the world's tuberculosis cases. India has the highest share among them. Global incidence and deaths have both fallen over the period from 2015 to 2024.

- 87% of the world's TB cases in 2024 were concentrated in 30 high-burden countries
- India accounts for the highest share: 25% of global TB cases
- Eight nations drive 67% of global TB cases in 2025, led by India, Indonesia (10%) and Philippines (6.8%)
- South-East Asia (34%), Western Pacific (27%) and Africa (25%) account for over 85% of the global TB burden in 2025
- Global TB incidence rate reduced by 12% between 2015 and 2024
- Global TB incidence was 131 per 100,000 in 2024
- Global TB deaths declined by 29% over the same period

Mind-map outline

Global TB burden and progress

- Concentration
  - 87% cases in 30 countries (2024)
  - India: 25% of global cases
  - Eight nations: 67% (2025)
- Regional share
  - South-East Asia: 34%
  - Western Pacific: 27%
  - Africa: 25%
- Progress since 2015
  - Incidence down 12%
  - Deaths down 29%
  - Incidence 131 per 100,000 (2024)

### India's initiatives and targets

India has launched campaigns and digital tools to accelerate TB elimination. Its National Strategic Plan for TB Elimination (2017-2025) sets goals for incidence and mortality by 2025. Patient support, community adoption and modern testing are also part of the response.

- TB Mukht Bharat Abhiyaan is a 100 Days Intensified Campaign to accelerate TB elimination
- TB Mukht Bharat App is a digital platform for monitoring, awareness and citizen participation
- TB Mukht Urban Ward Initiative targets urban TB hotspots with localised intervention
- National Strategic Plan (2017-2025) aims to eliminate TB five years ahead of global timelines
- Plan goals include 80% reduction in incidence and 90% mortality reduction by 2025
- Ni-Kshay Poshan Yojana gives monthly nutritional support of 1,000 through direct benefit transfer to registered TB patients
- Ni-Kshay Mitra: individuals, NGOs and corporates can adopt TB patients
- Truenat is a Polymerase Chain Reaction based molecular test
- India's TB incidence fell 21% since 2015, from 195 (2023) to 187 per 100,000 (2024)

Mind-map outline

India's TB response

- Campaigns and tools
  - TB Mukht Bharat Abhiyaan: 100 days
  - TB Mukht Bharat App: monitoring

- TB Mukht Urban Ward: urban hotspots
- Truenat: PCR-based test
- Patient support
  - Ni-Kshay Poshan: monthly support 1,000
  - Ni-Kshay Mitra: individuals adopt patients
- Targets for 2025
  - National plan 2017-2025: five years ahead
  - 80% incidence reduction
  - 90% mortality reduction

## Global strategy and partners

The WHO End TB Strategy (2015-2035) is a long-term global blueprint with targets for 2030. The Global Fund and the Stop TB Partnership support countries with finance, technical help and innovation. World TB Day, observed on March 24, marks the 1882 discovery of the TB bacterium by Robert Koch.

- World TB Day is observed on March 24 every year
- Robert Koch discovered the TB bacterium in 1882
- Theme 2026: 'Yes! We Can End TB: Led by Countries, Powered by People'
- WHO End TB Strategy (2015-2035) is a long-term global blueprint
- WHO End TB targets for 2030: 90% reduction in TB deaths and 80% reduction in TB incidence
- Global Fund and Stop TB Partnership provide financial and technical support
- Global Fund and Stop TB Partnership strengthen surveillance systems
- Global Fund and Stop TB Partnership promote innovation in diagnostics, treatment and preventive tools

Mind-map outline

Global strategy and partners

- WHO End TB Strategy
  - 2015-2035 long-term blueprint
  - 2030: 90% fewer TB deaths
  - 2030: 80% lower incidence
- Global Fund and Stop TB Partnership
  - Financial and technical support
  - Strengthen surveillance systems
  - Innovation in diagnostics and treatment
- World TB Day
  - Observed March 24
  - Robert Koch discovered bacterium, 1882

## Disease and drug resistance

Tuberculosis is caused by Mycobacterium tuberculosis and spreads through the air, but it is preventable and curable. Pulmonary TB is highly contagious, while extrapulmonary TB is less contagious. MDR-TB is resistant to first-line drugs and needs second-line drugs, longer treatment and higher spending.

- TB is caused by Mycobacterium tuberculosis
- TB is an airborne, contagious infectious disease
- TB is preventable and curable with timely diagnosis and appropriate treatment
- Pulmonary TB affects the lungs and is highly contagious
- Extrapulmonary TB affects organs outside the lungs and is less contagious
- First-line treatment drugs: Rifampicin, Isoniazid, Pyrazinamide, Ethambutol
- MDR-TB is resistant to Rifampicin and Isoniazid
- MDR-TB requires second-line drugs, longer treatment duration and higher cost
- MDR-TB is a major public health crisis and a global health security threat

Mnemonic - First-line TB treatment drugs: RIPE

R = Rifampicin; I = Isoniazid; P = Pyrazinamide; E = Ethambutol

Mind-map outline

Tuberculosis and drug resistance

- Cause and nature
  - Caused by Mycobacterium tuberculosis
  - Airborne, contagious, preventable, curable
- Forms
  - Pulmonary: lungs, highly contagious
  - Extrapulmonary: outside lungs, less contagious
- Treatment
  - First-line drugs (RIPE)
  - Rifampicin, Isoniazid, Pyrazinamide, Ethambutol
- MDR-TB
  - Resistant to rifampicin and isoniazid
  - Needs second-line drugs, longer treatment
  - Major public health crisis

## Miscellaneous

### Miscellaneous (Part 1)

#### Global Relations and Forums

India deepened ties with Brazil, Israel and Finland through trade, defence, technology and workforce arrangements. Brazil's state visit set a US\$30 billion bilateral trade target for 2030. The Takeshima/Dokdo islets dispute between Japan and South Korea remains a sovereignty issue rooted in Japan's colonial rule over Korea.

- Brazil-India Strategic Partnership dates to 2006; diplomatic relations were established in 1948.
- Bilateral trade target is US\$30 billion by 2030; trade had reached US\$15.21 billion in 2025.
- India and Brazil signed a Critical Minerals MoU covering rare earths, lithium, graphite, niobium and nickel.
- Embraer will set up an E175 jet assembly line with Adani Defence and Aerospace.
- Validity of multiple-entry tourist and business visas was extended from 5 years to 10 years.
- India and Israel upgraded ties to a Special Strategic Partnership for Peace, Innovation and Prosperity.
- Israel will allow up to 50,000 Indian workers over the next 5 years.
- Israel is India's 2nd largest trading partner in Asia; bilateral trade was US\$3.75 billion in FY 2024-25.
- Takeshima (Japan) and Dokdo (South Korea) are islets in the Sea of Japan; the 1951 San Francisco Peace Treaty did not name them explicitly.
- India and Finland elevated ties to a Strategic Partnership in digitalisation and sustainability; both aim to double bilateral trade by 2030.

Mind-map outline

Global Relations and Forums

- Brazil state visit
  - Trade target US\$30 billion by 2030
  - Critical minerals MoU
  - E175 jet assembly with Adani
- Israel ties
  - Special Strategic Partnership
  - Up to 50,000 Indian workers
  - UPI-Israel payment linkage explored
- Finland ties
  - Strategic partnership in digitalisation
  - Double trade by 2030
- Takeshima/Dokdo dispute
  - Japan: Takeshima (Bamboo Island)
  - South Korea: Dokdo (Solitary Island)

## Constitution, Law and Governance

The removal of a Chief Election Commissioner follows a special parliamentary process modelled on the removal of a Supreme Court judge, and no CEC has ever been removed. The Supreme Court recognises passive euthanasia under strict medical and judicial safeguards. Ladakh's demands for statehood and Sixth Schedule status, and the government's online takedown powers, are also in focus.

- Opposition parties moved a removal motion against CEC Gyanesh Kumar; no CEC has ever been removed in India.
- Under Article 324(5), the CEC can be removed in the same manner and on the same grounds as a Supreme Court judge.
- The CEC can be removed only on two grounds: proven misbehaviour and incapacity.
- A removal motion needs support of 100 Lok Sabha members or 50 Rajya Sabha members to be introduced.
- Both Houses must pass the motion with a majority of total membership and two-thirds of members present and voting, in the same session.
- Other Election Commissioners are removed by the President on the CEC's recommendation; Parliament is not involved.
- Ladakh has been a Union Territory without a legislature since 2019 and has only one Lok Sabha seat.
- Ladakh demands include Sixth Schedule inclusion, full statehood, a separate Public Service Commission and two Lok Sabha seats (Leh and Kargil).
- Common Cause v. Union of India (2018) legalised passive euthanasia and recognised living wills; active euthanasia remains illegal.
- Section 69A allows centralised blocking of online content, while Section 79(3)(b) allows direct takedown requests via the Sahyog Portal.

Mnemonic - CEC removal grounds: Only MI can remove the CEC

M = Misbehaviour, which must be proven; I = Incapacity

Mnemonic - Passive euthanasia safeguards: Let Patients Sleep Judiciously

L = Living will: no life support if terminally ill or in persistent vegetative state; P = Primary Medical

Board: doctors from the treating hospital; S = Secondary Medical Board: independent medical specialists; J = Judicial Magistrate: decision communicated for oversight

Mind-map outline

Constitution, Law and Governance

- CEC removal
  - Grounds: proven misbehaviour, incapacity
  - Motion: 100 LS or 50 RS members
  - Special majority in same session
- Ladakh demands
  - Sixth Schedule inclusion
  - Full statehood
  - Separate PSC and two LS seats
- Euthanasia framework
  - Passive permitted, active illegal
  - Living wills and two medical boards
  - Judicial Magistrate informed
- Contempt and censorship
  - Civil and criminal contempt
  - Section 69A: central blocking
  - Section 79(3)(b): Sahyog takedowns

## Public Health, Water and Environment

The Universal Immunisation Programme and Mission Indradhanush aim to protect children and pregnant women against vaccine-preventable diseases. Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0 extends rural tap water coverage to December 2028 with a focus on service delivery. India's biodiversity commitments under the CBD and the Nagoya Protocol centre on benefit-sharing and national reporting.

- The Universal Immunisation Programme is one of the largest public immunisation programmes in the world and was re-launched in 1985.
- Mission Indradhanush was launched on 25 December 2014 by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare.
- Intensified Mission Indradhanush 2.0 (December 2019) targeted districts with 70% or below immunisation coverage.
- India was certified polio-free in 2014; National Vaccination Day is observed on 16 March.
- U-WIN is a digital platform to track vaccination records.
- Jal Jeevan Mission was launched in 2019 under the Ministry of Jal Shakti with a standard of 55 litres per capita per day.
- Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0 is extended to December 2028 and aims at tap connections for all 19.36 crore rural households.
- Jal Arpan introduces a formal handover protocol involving Gram Panchayats and Village Water Committees (Paani Samitis).
- The Nagoya Protocol was adopted in 2010 at Nagoya (Japan) and entered into force in 2014.
- Out of 23 KMGBF targets, only 2 are on track for achievement by 2030; India hosts 98 Ramsar sites.

Mind-map outline

Public Health, Water and Environment

- Immunisation
  - UIP: free vaccines for children and pregnant women
  - Mission Indradhanush launched 2014
  - U-WIN tracks vaccination records
- Jal Jeevan Mission
  - JJM 2.0 runs till December 2028
  - Standard: 55 litres per capita per day
  - Jal Arpan handover to Paani Samitis
- Biodiversity
  - CBD adopted at 1992 Rio Earth Summit
  - Nagoya Protocol in force 2014
  - Access and benefit-sharing

## Economy, Security and Science

India's forex reserves fell by US\$7.052 billion, driven by dollar strength, RBI intervention and higher crude oil prices. The PRAHAAR framework sets out seven pillars of India's zero-tolerance counter-terror doctrine. Defence and navigation updates include Mudh-Nyoma Air Force Station in eastern Ladakh and the NavIC satellite system.

- India opposed including the IFD Agreement in the WTO framework; it is a plurilateral agreement binding only on signatories and based on the MFN principle.
- Forex reserves dropped by US\$7.052 billion to US\$709.759 billion; they are held by the Reserve Bank of India.
- Foreign currency assets are the largest component of forex reserves, followed by gold, SDRs and the reserve tranche position.
- NITI Aayog's Fiscal Health Index 2026 covers FY 2023-24 and relies on audited data from the CAG.
- Odisha retained the top position among major states for the second consecutive year.
- PRAHAAR is India's first comprehensive National Counter-Terrorism Policy Framework, institutionalising a zero-tolerance doctrine.
- PRAHAAR's seven pillars cover prevention, responses, aggregating internal synergy, human rights, attenuating radicalisation, aligning global cooperation and recovery.
- Mudh-Nyoma Air Force Station was built in 1962 at an elevation of 13,700 feet in Changthang, about 25 km from the LAC.

- NavIC is India's indigenous regional navigation system developed by ISRO and needs at least 4 operational satellites.
- Atomic clock failure on IRNSS-1F weakened NavIC, as functional satellites dropped from 4 to 3.

#### Mnemonic - PRAHAAR pillars: PRAHAAR

P = Proactive Intelligence: real-time sharing via Multi Agency Centre and Joint Task Force; R = Responses: swift action and rapid response to neutralise threats; A = Aggregating internal synergy: standard anti-terror structures and BPR&D training; H = Human rights: rule of law and fundamental rights protection; A = Attenuating radicalisation: engagement with NGOs and community leaders; A = Aligning global cooperation: MLATs and extradition treaties; R = Recovery and resilience: whole-of-society approach after attacks

#### Mind-map outline

##### Economy, Security and Science

- Forex reserves
  - Fell by US\$7.052 billion
  - Causes: dollar, RBI sales, crude oil
  - Held by RBI
- PRAHAAR
  - Seven pillars
  - Zero tolerance doctrine
  - Standard anti-terror structures
- Defence and navigation
  - Nyoma AFS at 13,700 feet
  - NavIC: needs at least 4 satellites
  - Atomic clocks maintained by CSIR-NPL

## History and Personalities

Shaheed Diwas recalls Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev and Shivaram Hari Rajguru, who were linked to the Lahore Conspiracy Case. The Dandi March of 1930 marked the formal launch of the Civil Disobedience Movement through defiance of the salt law. C. Rajagopalachari (Rajaji) and the ASMITA Athletics League complete this section.

- Shaheed Diwas is observed on 23 March; India also observes Martyrs' Day on 30 January.
- Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev and Rajguru were executed in 1931 at the Lahore Central Jail.
- Bhagat Singh founded the Naujawan Bharat Sabha in 1926; the HSRA was formed in 1928.
- In the Lahore Conspiracy Case, Lala Lajpat Rai was fatally injured in a 1928 lathi charge during protest against the Simon Commission.
- The Central Assembly Bombing of 1929 was carried out by Bhagat Singh with Batukeshwar Dutt.
- The Dandi March started on 12 March 1930 from Sabarmati Ashram and ended on 6 April 1930 at Dandi in Gujarat.
- The Salt Act of 1882 gave the British colonial government exclusive control over salt production and distribution.
- Rajaji was born on 10 December 1878 at Thorapalli (Tamil Nadu) and proposed the C.R. Formula in 1944.
- Rajaji was the only Indian and the last Governor-General of India, serving from 1948 to 1950.
- The ASMITA Athletics League was launched across 250 locations to promote women's participation in sports.

#### Mind-map outline

##### History and Personalities

- Shaheed Diwas
  - Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, Rajguru
  - Executed 1931, Lahore Central Jail
  - Lahore Conspiracy Case
- Dandi March, 1930
  - Sabarmati Ashram to Dandi
  - Defied Salt Act 1882
  - Triggered by rejected 11-point demands
- Rajaji
  - Vedaranyam salt march, 1930

- C.R. Formula, 1944
- Swatantra Party, 1959
- ASMITA Athletics League
  - Launched across 250 locations
  - Linked to Khelo India

## Miscellaneous (Part 2)

### Oscars 2026 and Indian Oscar winners

The 98th Academy Awards were held in Los Angeles to celebrate excellence in global cinema, and the Oscars are presented by the Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences (USA). The 2026 Best Picture was One Battle After Another, and Paul Thomas Anderson won Best Director. The booklet also records Oscar milestones, such as Wings as the first Best Picture winner and Walt Disney's record of 22 Oscars.

- The 98th Academy Awards were held in Los Angeles to celebrate excellence in global cinema.
- The Oscars are presented by the Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences (USA).
- Louis B. Mayer, co-founder of MGM Studios, conceptualised the Oscars.
- The Oscars honour artistic and technical achievements, including acting, directing and writing.
- Oscar categories started at 12 and have now expanded to 24.
- The Oscar statuette is gold-plated bronze and shows a knight standing on a reel of film holding a sword.
- Wings was the first Best Picture winner.
- Walt Disney holds the record for the most Oscars (22).
- Katharine Hepburn leads in acting wins, with 4 Best Actress awards.
- 2026: Best Picture was One Battle After Another; Best Director was Paul Thomas Anderson.
- Indian winners at the Academy Awards listed in the booklet include Bhanu Athaiya, Guneet Monga and Resul Pookutty.

Mind-map outline

Oscars 2026 and Indian Oscar winners

- Organisation
  - Academy of Motion Picture Arts and Sciences (USA)
  - Conceptualised by Louis B. Mayer
- Records
  - Wings: first Best Picture
  - Walt Disney: most Oscars (22)
  - Katharine Hepburn: 4 Best Actress wins
- 2026 winners
  - Best Picture: One Battle After Another
  - Best Director: Paul Thomas Anderson
- Indian winners named
  - Bhanu Athaiya
  - Guneet Monga
  - Resul Pookutty

### BAFTA Awards 2026 and India's BAFTA history

The British Academy of Film and Television Arts (BAFTA) presents its awards annually from London. At the 2026 BAFTA Awards, One Battle After Another won Best Film and Hamnet won Outstanding British Film. Boong, a Manipuri film, became the first Indian film to win Best Children's and Family Film, and earlier Indian milestones include Rohini Hattangadi's win and A.R. Rahman's Best Film Music award.

- BAFTA was established in 1947 and presents its awards annually.
- BAFTA is presented by the British Academy of Film and Television Arts and is based in London, United Kingdom.
- BAFTA covers Film, Television, Games and Children's & Family Content.
- 2026 Best Film: One Battle After Another; Best Director: Paul Thomas Anderson.
- 2026 Outstanding British Film: Hamnet; Best Leading Actress: Jessie Buckley (Hamnet).

- 2026 Best Leading Actor: Robert Aramayo (I Swear).
- Boong became the first Indian film to win Best Children's and Family Film at the BAFTA Awards 2026.
- Boong is a Manipuri film directed by Lakshmipriya Devi and produced by Farhan Akhtar and Ritesh Sidhwani.
- Rohini Hattangadi was the first Indian actor to win a competitive BAFTA, for Best Supporting Actress in Gandhi (1983).
- Asif Kapadia won Best British Film for The Warrior (2002); A.R. Rahman won Best Film Music for Slumdog Millionaire (2009).

Mind-map outline

BAFTA Awards 2026 and India

- BAFTA profile
  - Established 1947, annual
  - Based in London, UK
- 2026 key awards
  - Best Film: One Battle After Another
  - Leading Actress: Jessie Buckley
- Indian milestones
  - Boong: Children's and Family Film
  - Rohini Hattangadi: Gandhi (1983)
  - Asif Kapadia: The Warrior (2002)
  - A.R. Rahman: Slumdog Millionaire (2009)

## Jnanpith and Sahitya Akademi awards

R. Vairamuthu was selected for the 60th Jnanpith Award 2025, becoming the third Tamil writer to receive it. The Jnanpith, instituted in 1961, is India's oldest and highest literary honour and is not awarded posthumously. The Sahitya Akademi Awards 2025 honoured 24 authors for outstanding literary works across Indian languages.

- R. Vairamuthu was selected for the 60th Jnanpith Award 2025.
- Vairamuthu is the third Tamil writer to receive the Jnanpith, after Akilan (1975) and Jayakanthan (2002).
- Vairamuthu is the first Tamil writer primarily recognised for poetry to receive the Jnanpith.
- The Jnanpith was instituted in 1961 and established by Sahu Shanti Prasad Jain and his wife Rama Jain.
- The first Jnanpith was awarded in 1965 to G. Sankara Kurup, a Malayalam writer.
- Ashapoorna Devi (1976, Prothom Protishruti) was the first woman recipient of the Jnanpith.
- Amitav Ghosh (2018) was the first English-language winner of the Jnanpith.
- The Jnanpith recognises lifetime contribution, is not awarded posthumously and is given to Indian authors only.
- Sahitya Akademi Awards 2025 honoured 24 authors, including Navtej Sarna for Crimson Spring (English novel).
- Sahitya Akademi Awards are awarded to Indian citizens and cover 24 languages, including English and Rajasthani.

Mnemonic - Jnanpith firsts: KDG: Kurup first in sixty-five, Devi in seventy-six, Ghosh in eighteen  
K = G. Sankara Kurup: first Jnanpith award, 1965 (Malayalam writer); D = Ashapoorna Devi: first woman recipient, 1976; G = Amitav Ghosh: first English-language winner, 2018

Mind-map outline

Jnanpith and Sahitya Akademi

- Jnanpith
  - Instituted 1961; Sahu Shanti Prasad Jain
  - First award 1965: G. Sankara Kurup
  - First woman: Ashapoorna Devi (1976)
  - First English-language: Amitav Ghosh (2018)
- 2025 winners
  - Jnanpith: R. Vairamuthu (60th)
  - Sahitya Akademi: 24 authors

## ASMITA Initiative

ASMITA stands for Achieving Sports Milestone by Inspiring Women Through Action and was launched in 2021 by the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports. It was earlier known as Khelo India Women's League. The initiative aims to promote sports participation among girls and women at the grassroots level and to identify and nurture young sporting talent, especially from rural and tribal areas.

- ASMITA stands for Achieving Sports Milestone by Inspiring Women Through Action.
- ASMITA was launched in 2021 by the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports.
- ASMITA was earlier known as Khelo India Women's League.
- Objective: promote sports participation among girls and women at the grassroots level.
- Objective: identify and nurture young sporting talent, especially from rural and tribal areas.

Mnemonic - ASMITA acronym: A Super Mind Inspires True Action

A = Achieving; S = Sports; M = Milestone; I = Inspiring; T = Through; A = Action

Mind-map outline

ASMITA Initiative

- Origin
  - Launched 2021, Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports
  - Earlier: Khelo India Women's League
- Objectives
  - Sports participation for girls and women
  - Nurture young talent in rural and tribal areas

## AILET Corner

### March 2026 Current Affairs Round-up

#### Governance, Schemes and Infrastructure

This subtopic covers the NOTA voting option, the PM Surya Ghar rooftop solar scheme, the Sujal Gaon ID for rural piped water schemes, and the Nammo Bharat rapid transit system. Each item is a domestic initiative with a defined objective, implementing body or ministry, and timeline.

- NOTA allows voters to reject all candidates in an election while still taking part in the democratic process.
- NOTA was introduced by the Supreme Court in PUCI vs Union of India (2013).
- The Supreme Court observed that NOTA has had limited impact on parties' candidate selection over a decade.
- NOTA was used in the 2013 Assembly Elections in Chhattisgarh, Mizoram, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Delhi.
- PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana was launched in 2024 and is described as the world's largest domestic rooftop solar initiative.
- Target: rooftop solar in 1 crore households, with free electricity up to 300 units per month.
- Financial support: subsidy of up to 40% of installation cost; nodal ministry is MNRE; scheme runs till FY 2026-27.
- Sujal Gaon ID, launched by the Ministry of Jal Shakti, digitally maps rural piped water schemes under Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0.
- Each Sujal Gaon ID is linked to a Sujalam Bharat ID.
- Nammo Bharat RRTS is a rail-based semi-high speed (up to 180 km/h) commuter system for inter-city travel within the NCR, implemented by NCRTC.

Mnemonic - PM Surya Ghar numbers: One Crore Homes, Three Hundred Units, Forty Percent  
One Crore Homes = Target number of households for rooftop solar installation; Three Hundred Units = Free electricity units per month under the scheme; Forty Percent = Maximum subsidy on installation cost

Mind-map outline

Governance and schemes

- NOTA
  - Introduced by Supreme Court, 2013
  - Lets voters reject all candidates

- PM Surya Ghar
  - Launched 2024
  - Target: 1 crore households
  - Subsidy up to 40%
- Sujal Gaon ID
  - Ministry of Jal Shakti
  - Linked to Sujalam Bharat ID
- Namo Bharat RRTS
  - Up to 180 km/h
  - Implemented by NCRTC

## International Organisations and Regional Groupings

This subtopic covers the World Health Organization, the Commission on the Status of Women, the BIMSTEC grouping and the Three Seas Initiative. Argentina's exit from the WHO and India's standing in the CSW are the main current developments.

- WHO is a specialised agency of the United Nations responsible for global public health governance.
- WHO's constitution was drafted in 1946; the organisation came into force on 7 April 1948 and has 192 member States.
- WHO functions through six regional offices and is headquartered in Geneva, Switzerland.
- Argentina is exiting the WHO after a one-year notice, citing sovereignty concerns and dissatisfaction with the COVID-19 response.
- The Commission on the Status of Women was established in 1946 as the principal intergovernmental body of the UN for gender equality and women's empowerment.
- The Commission functions under ECOSOC, receives secretariat support from UN Women, and has 45 member States elected for four-year terms.
- India was elected to the Commission for 2021-25 and re-elected for 2025-29.
- BIMSTEC (Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation) was established in 1997 by the Bangkok Declaration and has 7 member countries.
- India hosted the BIMSTEC Youth Heritage and Sustainability Programme in Madhya Pradesh, organised by the Ministry of External Affairs and Bharat Scouts.
- The Three Seas Initiative is a regional platform of 13 EU countries located between three seas; it was initiated in 2016 by Poland and Croatia.

Mnemonic - BIMSTEC member countries: I Bet Banana Nectar Serves Many Tourists

I = India; B = Bangladesh and Bhutan; N = Nepal; S = Sri Lanka; M = Myanmar; T = Thailand

Mind-map outline

International organisations

- WHO
  - UN specialised agency
  - HQ Geneva
  - 192 member States
- Commission on Status of Women
  - Established 1946
  - Works under ECOSOC
  - Secretariat: UN Women
- BIMSTEC
  - Established 1997
  - 7 member countries
- Three Seas Initiative
  - Initiated 2016
  - 13 EU countries

## Trade and Energy Diplomacy

This subtopic covers the Most Favoured Nation principle in WTO trade, the India-EU services agreement, the Texas oil refinery project, and the characteristics of light shale oil. The MFN rule is the main trade concept tested here.

- Most Favoured Nation (MFN) requires a country to treat all WTO members equally in trade concessions.

- If a country gives lower tariffs, market access or favourable treatment to one country, it must extend the same to all WTO members.
- MFN ensures non-discriminatory global trade.
- India and the EU agreed to grant MFN status in trade in services for 5 years.
- Reliance Industries Limited was announced as a key partner in the \$300 billion Texas Oil Refinery Project.
- The Texas refinery is a major new oil refinery constructed in the USA since 1977, developed by America First Refining.
- The refinery is located in the Permian Basin (the largest oil-producing region in the USA) and at the Port of Brownsville in South Texas.
- Light shale oil is a low-density crude trapped in low-permeability shale or tight sandstone formations.
- Light shale oil has low sulphur content and a high hydrogen-to-carbon ratio.

Mnemonic - MFN rule: Give one, give all

Give one = A lower tariff or favourable treatment granted to one country; give all = Must be extended to all WTO members

Mind-map outline

Trade and energy diplomacy

- MFN
  - Equal treatment of WTO members
  - India-EU: services for 5 years
- Texas refinery
  - Reliance Industries as partner
  - Permian Basin, Port of Brownsville
- Light shale oil
  - Low-density crude
  - Low sulphur content

## Environment, Wildlife and Space

This subtopic covers the National Highways Green Cover Index, Project Cheetah, Him-CONNECT and asteroid 2024 YR4. Each item names an implementing body, a key figure or date, and a specific programme or discovery detail.

- NHA released the first annual report of its National Highways Green Cover Index for 2025-26, prepared in collaboration with the National Remote Sensing Centre (ISRO).
- The Green Cover Assessment surveyed 30,000 km of National Highways across 24 States.
- The index uses high-resolution satellite imagery from Resourcesat-2 and Resourcesat-2A.
- Assam recorded the highest highway green cover at 53.16%, followed by Gujarat and Telangana.
- Project Cheetah is India's flagship wildlife conservation initiative, launched in 2022 and implemented by the National Tiger Conservation Authority (MoEFCC).
- Project Cheetah operates under the umbrella of Project Tiger and aims to reintroduce cheetahs, officially extinct in India since 1952.
- Cheetahs were brought from Namibia (8, in 2022) and South Africa (12, in 2023), and 9 cheetahs from Botswana arrived at Kuno National Park.
- Him-CONNECT, launched by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change at WSDS 2026, bridges high-level scientific research and grassroots entrepreneurship.
- Him-CONNECT was developed under the National Mission on Himalayan Studies to link research with implementation in the Himalayan region.
- Asteroid 2024 YR4 was discovered in 2024 by the ATLAS observatory in Chile; NASA confirmed it will not hit the Moon after James Webb Space Telescope observations.
- Asteroid 2024 YR4 is an S-type asteroid of the Apollo group, composed mainly of silicate minerals and nickel-iron metals.

Mind-map outline

Environment, wildlife and space

- Green Cover Index
  - NHA with NRSC (ISRO)
  - 30,000 km across 24 States
  - Assam highest at 53.16%
- Project Cheetah

- Kuno National Park
- Under Project Tiger
- Extinct in India since 1952
- Him-CONNECT
  - Launched at WSDS 2026
  - National Mission on Himalayan Studies
- Asteroid 2024 YR4
  - Discovered 2024 by ATLAS, Chile
  - S-type asteroid

## Sports and Places in News

This subtopic covers the first Khelo India Tribal Games, scheduled for Chhattisgarh in 2026, and the Lipulekh Pass, which is set to reopen for border trade with China. The Games aim to bring tribal sporting talent into the national ecosystem.

- The Khelo India Scheme was launched in 2016-17 by the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports.
- Chhattisgarh is set to host the first-ever Khelo India Tribal Games in 2026.
- The Tribal Games integrate tribal sporting talent into India's national sports ecosystem while preserving traditional indigenous games.
- Sports included in the Tribal Games: Mallakhamb and Kabaddi.
- Organising bodies: Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports, Sports Authority of India and Indian Olympic Association.
- Morveer is the mascot, representing pride, bravery and cultural identity of tribal communities.
- Lipulekh Pass is in the Kumaon region of Uttarakhand and is a tri-junction of India, Nepal and China (Tibet region).
- India is set to resume border trade with China via Lipulekh Pass after a six-year COVID-induced suspension.
- Lipulekh Pass is a key route for the Kailash Mansarovar Yatra.

Mind-map outline

Sports and places in news

- Khelo India Tribal Games
  - Host: Chhattisgarh, 2026
  - Sports: Mallakhamb, Kabaddi
  - Mascot: Morveer
- Lipulekh Pass
  - Kumaon, Uttarakhand
  - Border trade with China resuming
  - Kailash Mansarovar Yatra route